SPARQL queries for Project Jarāʾid

List of linked queries and screenshots of their results

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General remarks

Modularity

The SPARQL queries in this repository are largely modularised utilising Blazegraphe extensions. This allows for some plug-and-play approach in chaining modules together but limits the SPARQL engine to Wikidata's endpoints.

Language of results

The language of results will depend on your operating system's language. To change this behaviour and explicitly set a target language, one has to change `[AUTO_LANGUAGE]` in the following line to some 2-character ISO language tag:

```
bd:serviceParam wikibase:language "[AUTO_LANGUAGE]".
```

File naming conventions

- file names begin with the item type to be returned, such as `periodicals`, `editors`, `holdings`, `languages` etc.

- file names use key-value pairs. Keys are separated by dashes and values by underscores: `-key_value-key_value`.
  - take for example the language of periodicals, which uses the `lang` key and ISO or BCP47 language codes, i.e. `lang_ar` for Arabic.
- The type of display resulting from a SPARQL query is suffixed to the file name using the `disp` key:
  - nothing or `disp_table`: the default table view
  - `disp_bubble`: `#defaultView:BubbleChart`
  - `disp_map`: `#defaultView:Map{"hide":["?coords"]}`
  - `disp_graph`: `#defaultView:Graph`
- reusable subqueries are marked with the prefix `subquery_`

Links to queries

Most queries are far too long for Wikimedia's link shortener, which is otherwise a great option for sharing due to the human-readability of the short links. But all non-ASCII characters have to be URL-encoded and the link shortener enforces a limit of 2.000 characters. I had therefore originally submitted almost all queries to the query chest service. However, as I should have known, shortened links are particularly prone to link rot and Query Chest has seemingly flushed its caches at some point in mid-July 2026. I have therefore reverted to linking full URLs despite them being extremely long and cumbersome.

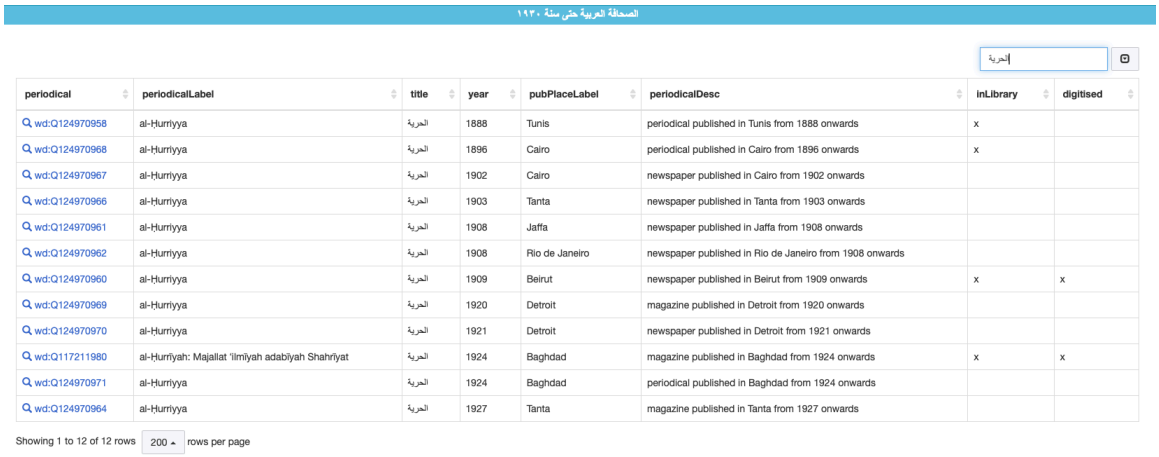
Basic queries

List of Arabic periodicals

A basic table of all Arabic periodicals published before 1930 sorted by date and including binary toggle for whether there are holdings and digitised copies.

Note that only Arabic titles are returned and that the language of the item label depends on your operating systems language settings.

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-basic`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/5NZuEN6OBMmiWm0IoYYU6caa2q6AKeqUKEKe0uqy4Ml


الصحافة العربية حتى سنة ١٩٣٠

الحرية

periodical	periodicalLabel	title	year	pubPlaceLabel	periodicalDesc	inLibrary	digitised
wd:Q124970958	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1888	Tunis	periodical published in Tunis from 1888 onwards	x	
wd:Q124970968	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1896	Cairo	periodical published in Cairo from 1896 onwards	x	
wd:Q124970967	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1902	Cairo	newspaper published in Cairo from 1902 onwards		
wd:Q124970966	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1903	Tanta	newspaper published in Tanta from 1903 onwards		
wd:Q124970961	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1908	Jaffa	newspaper published in Jaffa from 1908 onwards		
wd:Q124970962	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1908	Rio de Janeiro	newspaper published in Rio de Janeiro from 1908 onwards		
wd:Q124970960	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1909	Beirut	newspaper published in Beirut from 1909 onwards	x	x
wd:Q124970969	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1920	Detroit	magazine published in Detroit from 1920 onwards		
wd:Q124970970	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1921	Detroit	newspaper published in Detroit from 1921 onwards		
wd:Q117211980	al-Ḥurrīyah: Majallat ʻilmīyah adabīyah Shahrīyat	الحرية	1924	Baghdad	magazine published in Baghdad from 1924 onwards	x	x
wd:Q124970971	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1924	Baghdad	periodical published in Baghdad from 1924 onwards		
wd:Q124970964	al-Ḥurriyya	الحرية	1927	Tanta	magazine published in Tanta from 1927 onwards		

Showing 1 to 12 of 12 rows 200 rows per page

List of Arabic periodicals by number of holdings

Arabic periodicals, ranked by number of collections. Note that one can easily switch to a bubble graph with the left-hand menu.

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-holdings-count`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/wnhAUtiqI4MQyW0MOsqAyOqOwSuE6iSUcU28oCUAqkY

List of Arabic periodicals by number of digitised collections

Arabic periodicals, ranked by number of digitised collections

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-digitised-count`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/JwwYdMXGLosUGeSKCucwckW0gMmEqAY2Uosa2MiMYev

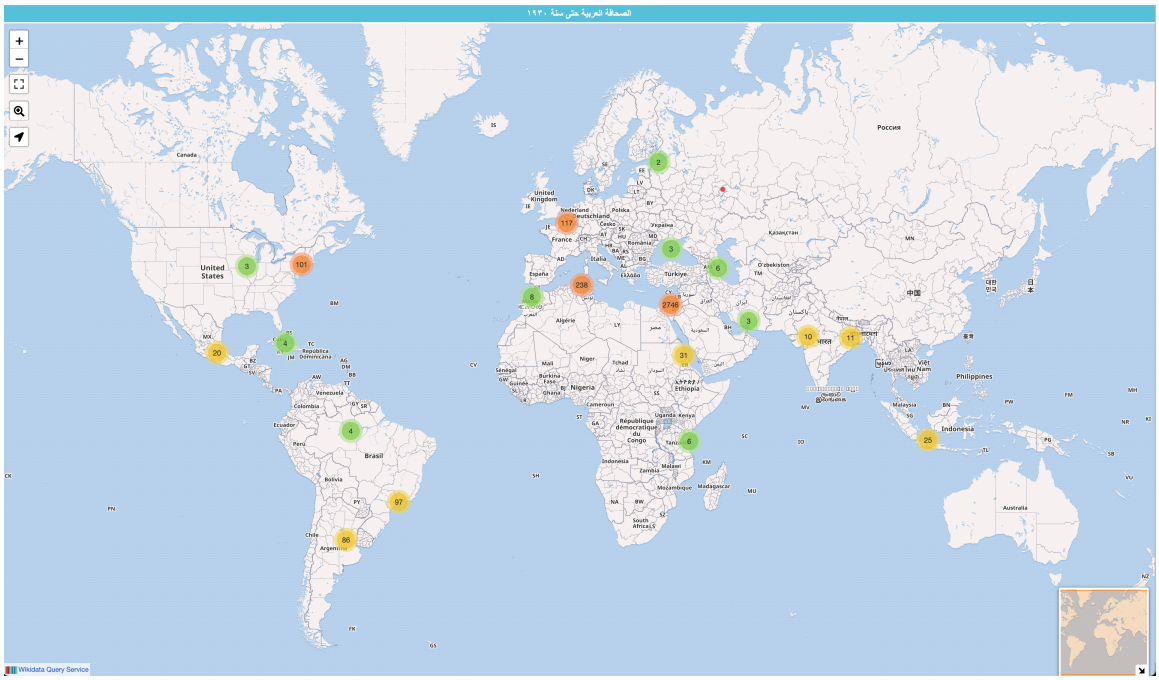
Maps

The queries in this section all produce maps with cluster markers for publication locations of periodicals published before 1930

Map of Arabic periodicals

Map of all Arabic periodicals

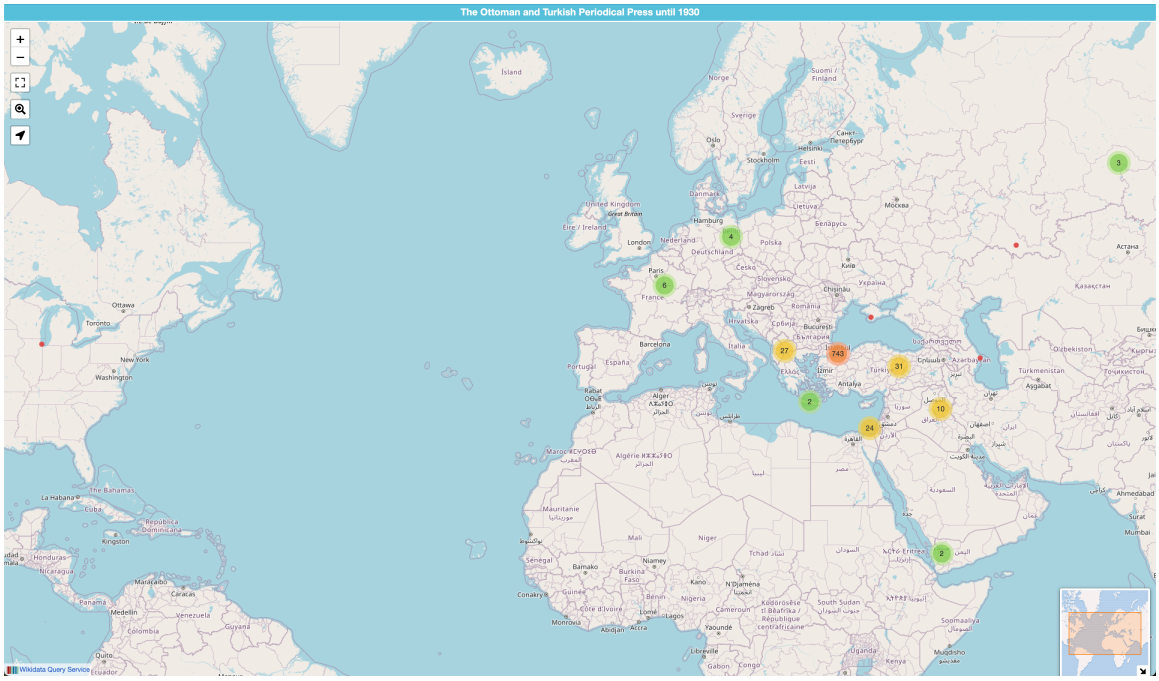
- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-basic-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/KkTnCUlWc4MI6WKwSm6CeY4GM8EGOyScEsi4Sw0oOq4



Map of Ottoman periodicals

Map of all Ottoman periodicals. Otherwise similar to the preceding map

- name: `periodicals-lang_ota-basic-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: <https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/wLTnRa9d2GceWkacK6Ek8uSUaWIGaamSsqe8C6kaMCI >



Historical stages of the data set

Periodicals edited within the last week

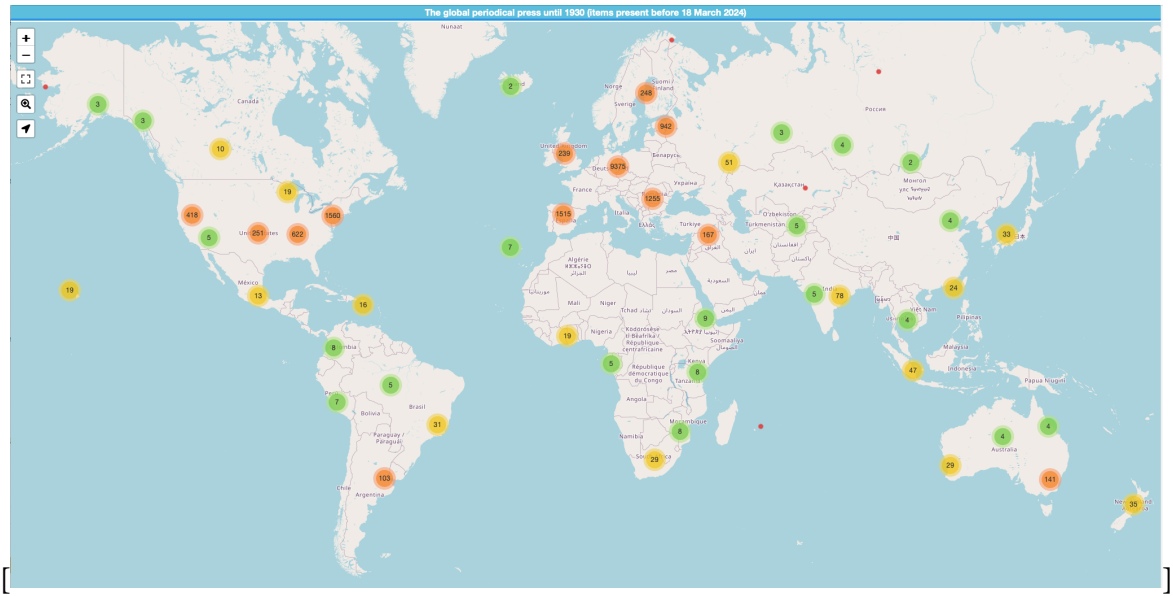
- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-modified_last-week-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata

Some description

Map of all periodicals before our import

Map of all items for periodicals that were created before 18 March 2024

- name: `periodicals-before-2024-03-18-disp_map`
- link: [SPARQL query on Wikidata][rq:periodicals-before-2024-03-18-disp_map]
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/8K4bVhyOmm6seAwkmiIqsGEEY4yCooU6YMGsKSYQ2Eb

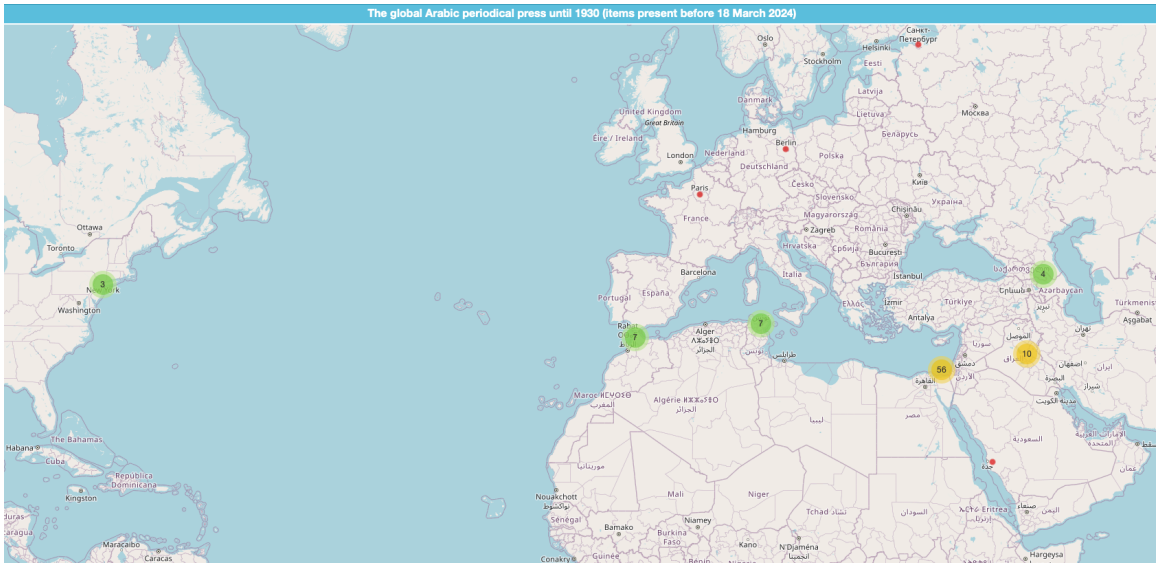


[rq:periodicals-before-2024-03-18-disp_map]

Map of Arabic periodicals before our import

Map of all items for Arabic periodicals that were created before 18 March 2024

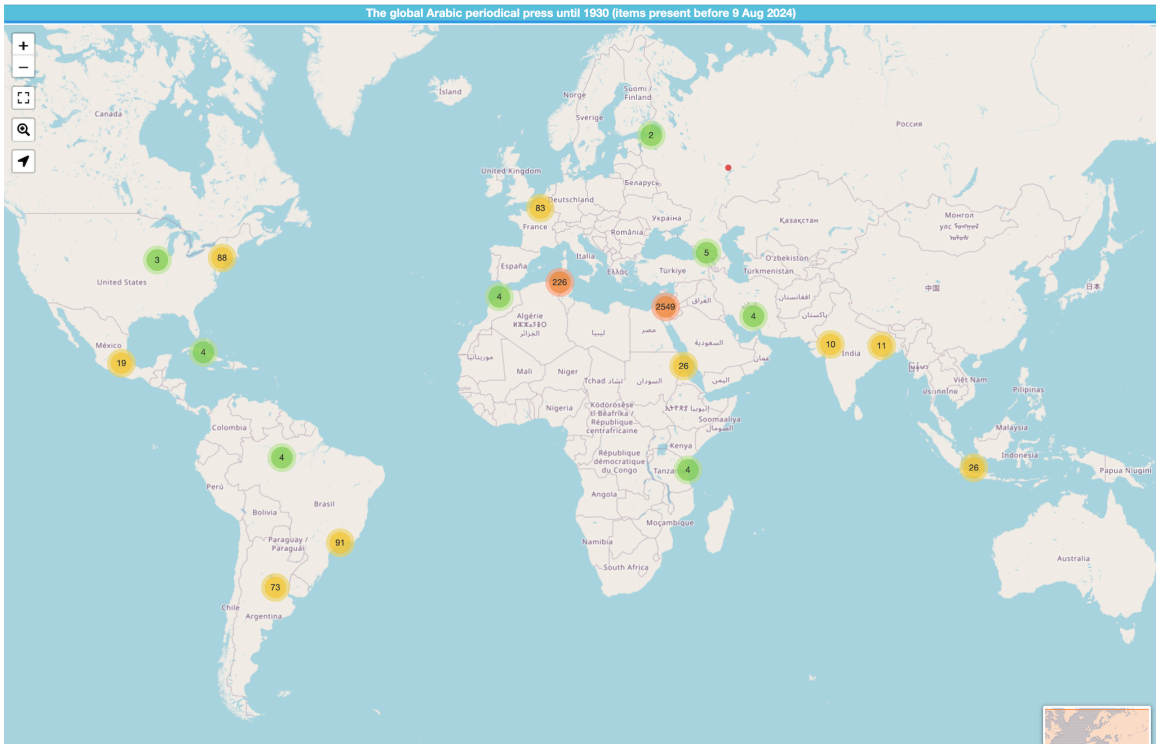
- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-before-2024-03-18-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/LAwIgT9wqucyaW0mCQ0Ms2uKGUmygM6mwcSIuKKKyc0



Map of Arabic periodicals before after import

Map of all items for Arabic periodicals that were created until 8 August 2024

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-before-2024-08-08-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/obqUZJy6sY448EAesSQSaW80kAsYucuIiE8sO8kY2Gd

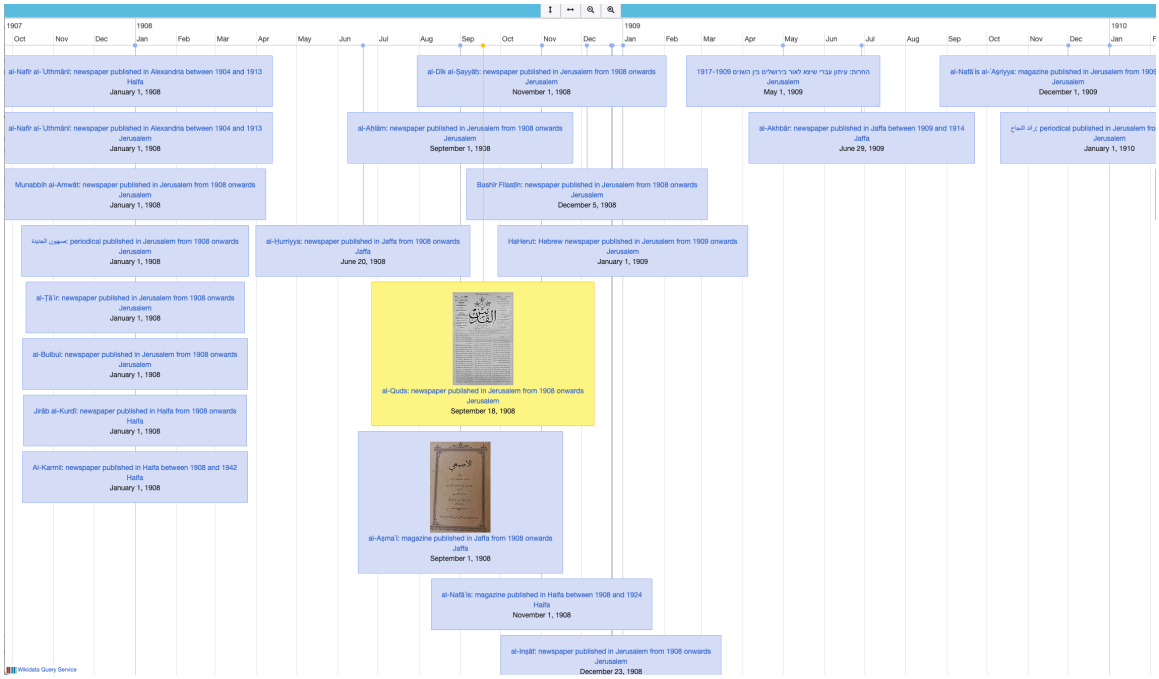


Timelines

Timeline of Palestinian periodicals

Timeline of all periodicals published in pre-Nakba Palestine

- name: `palestine-1948_periodicals_timeline`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/fVec4Zl0eOOWc2k6oMA6aq0CcUqQi2GeIu4oMo4Kioo



counts

Simple counts for documentary purposes

1. All periodicals on Wikidata (items created before 18 March 2024)
2. Arabic periodicals on Wikidata (items created before 18 March 2024)
3. Arabic periodicals on Wikidata (items created before 8 August 2024)

Count of digitised collections per periodical

Count of digitised collections for each Arabic periodical. Returns a table sorted by the number of collections in descending order.

This table illustrates the uncoordinated nature of scanning and digitising efforts.

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-digitised-count`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/JwwYdMXGLosUGeSKCucwckW0gMmEqAY2Uosa2MiMYev

No. of digitised collections for Arabic periodicals

Search

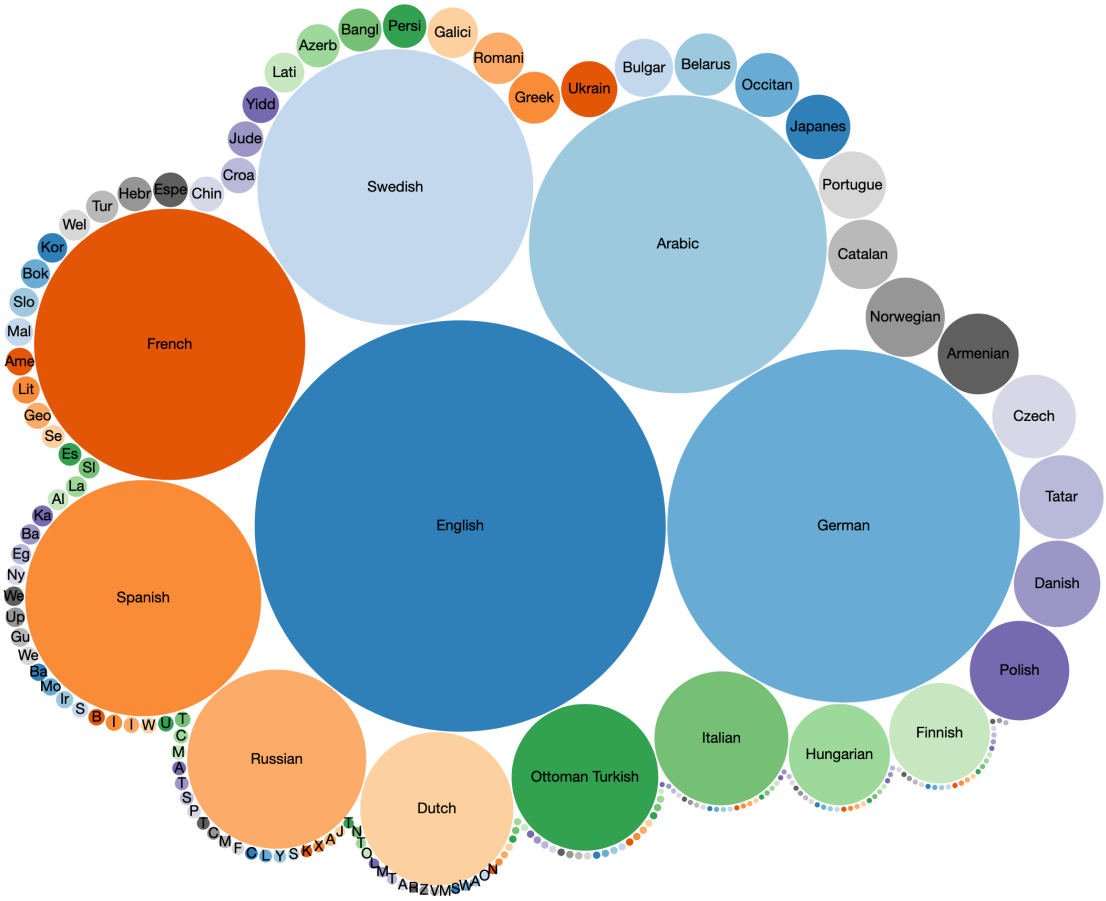
periodical	periodicalLabel	digitisedCollections
wd:Q15856582	Al-Hilal	10
wd:Q22018602	Az-Zuhur	9
wd:Q6033538	Al-Muqtataf	8
wd:Q4118576	Al-Musawar	6
wd:Q124975232	الاحصاء السنوي العامة للقطر المصري	6
wd:Q19259751	At-Tabib	6
wd:Q17521078	Ad-Diya	6
wd:Q12237314	Lughat al-Arab	5
wd:Q107281099	Al Ustadh (magazine)	5
wd:Q21605653	Al-Bayan (journal)	5
wd:Q204155	Al-Machriq	5

Publication languages

Bubble chart of publication languages

Bubble chart of publication languages for all periodicals published before 1930. The size of bubbles correspondes to the number of periodicals published in that language.

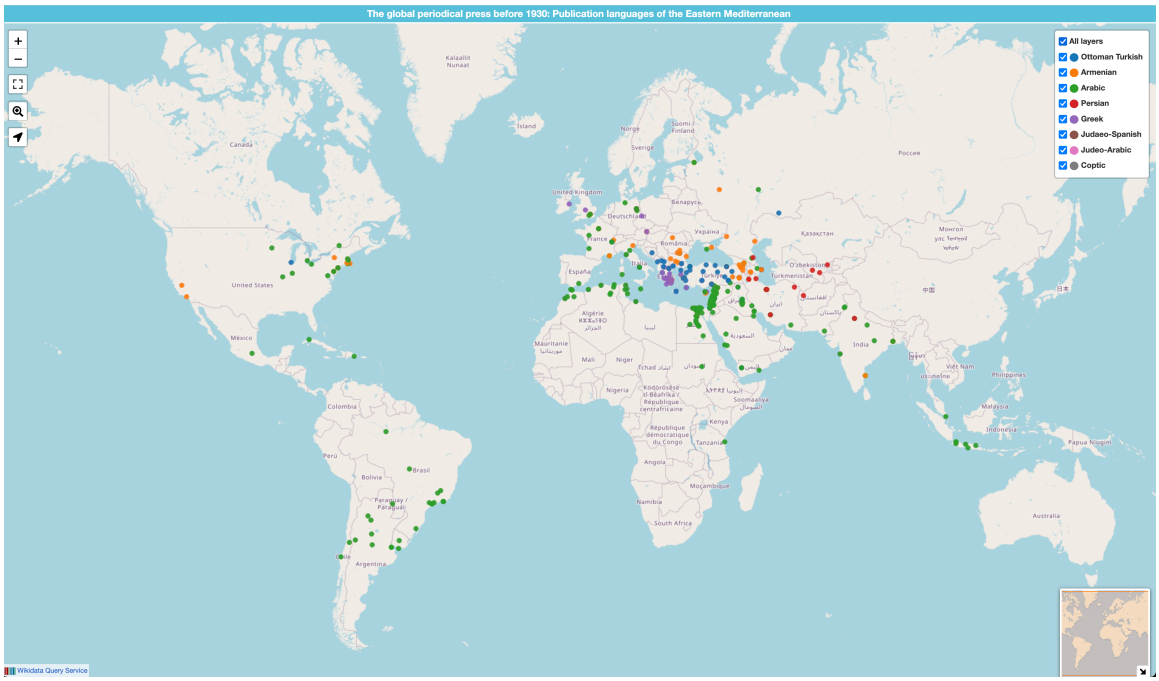
- name: `languages-disp_bubble`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata



Map of publication languages

Map of periodicals published in the languages of the Eastern Mediterranean and before 1930. Each language is displayed by dots in a different colour.

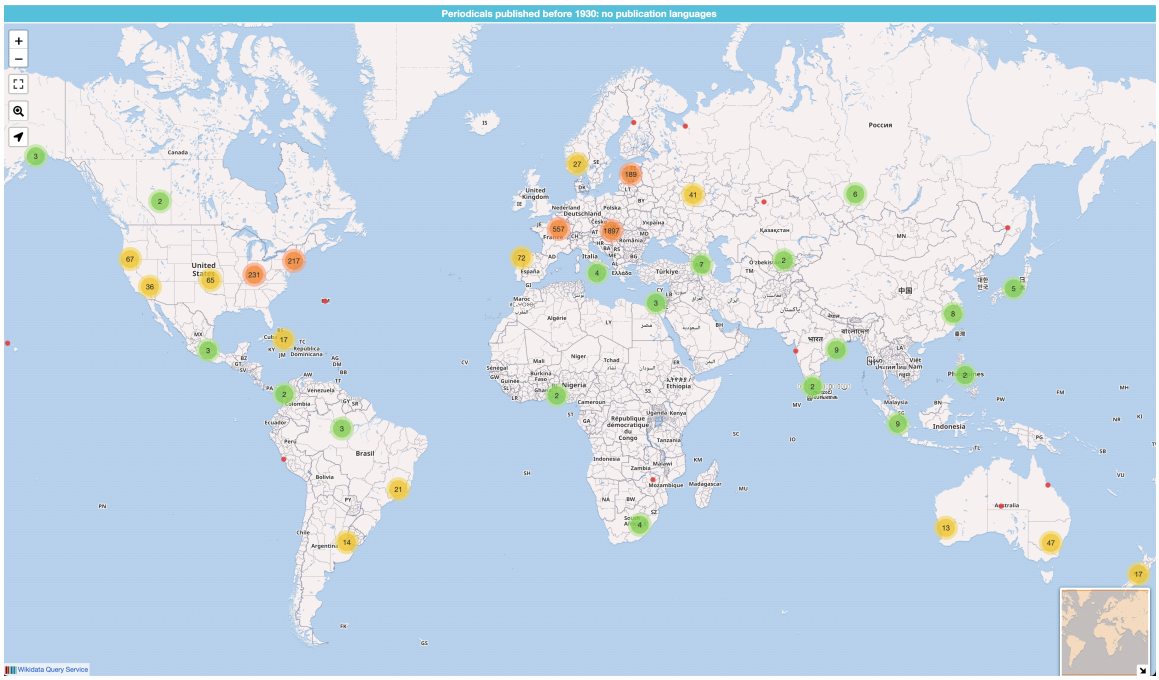
- name: `periodicals-layers_languages-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/uAOfzguDGgAA6Ma2yseCsOOmGOOmaq8Go6sQQ6YEMWh



Periodicals without publication languages

Map of periodicals published before 1930 without a recorded publication language. This view helps to determine whether a periodical might be of interest to us.

- name: `periodicals-filter_missing-lang`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/xXzyJrwD4qGACuAcayGyGEW4AUE8G8Y8wmCMc8cqKwG

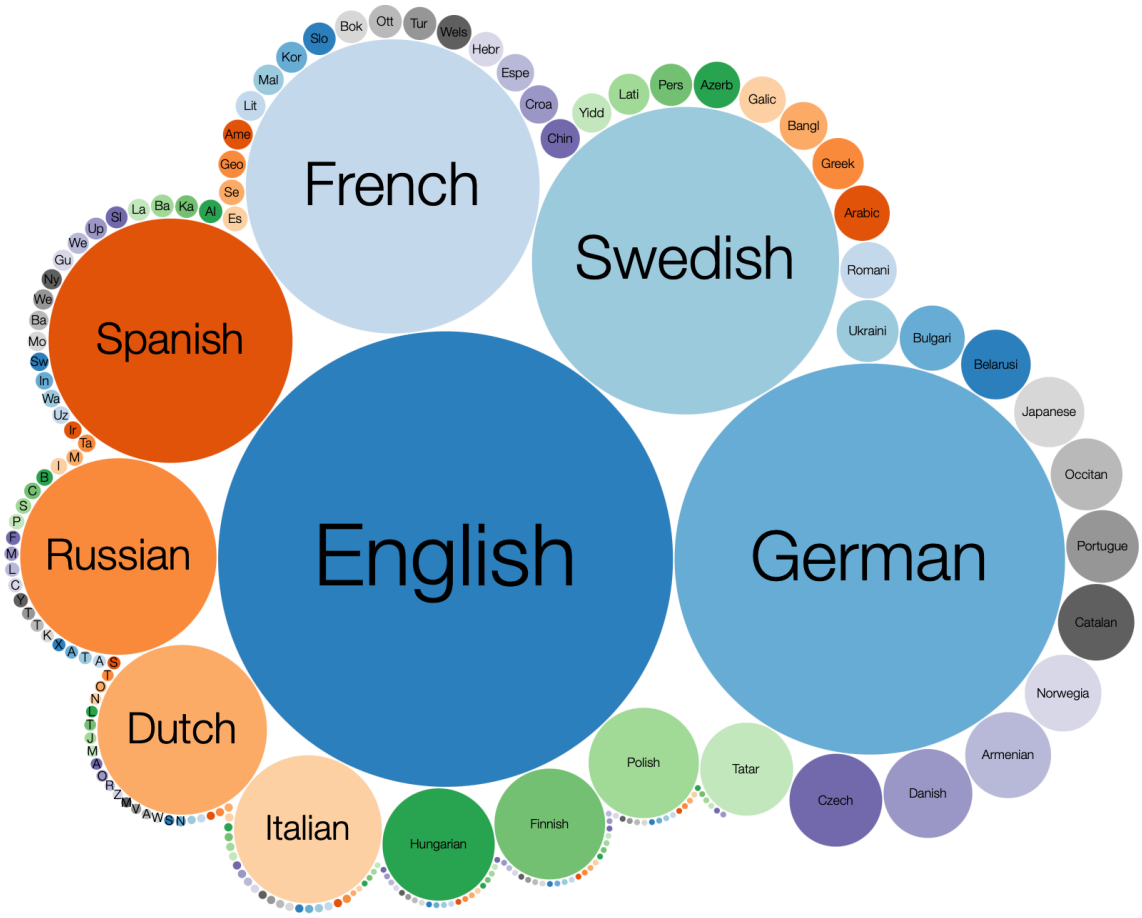


Historical stages of the data set

Publication languages on Wikidata before our import

Bubble chart of publication languages (items created before 18 March 2024). Note the surprising prominence of Swedish.

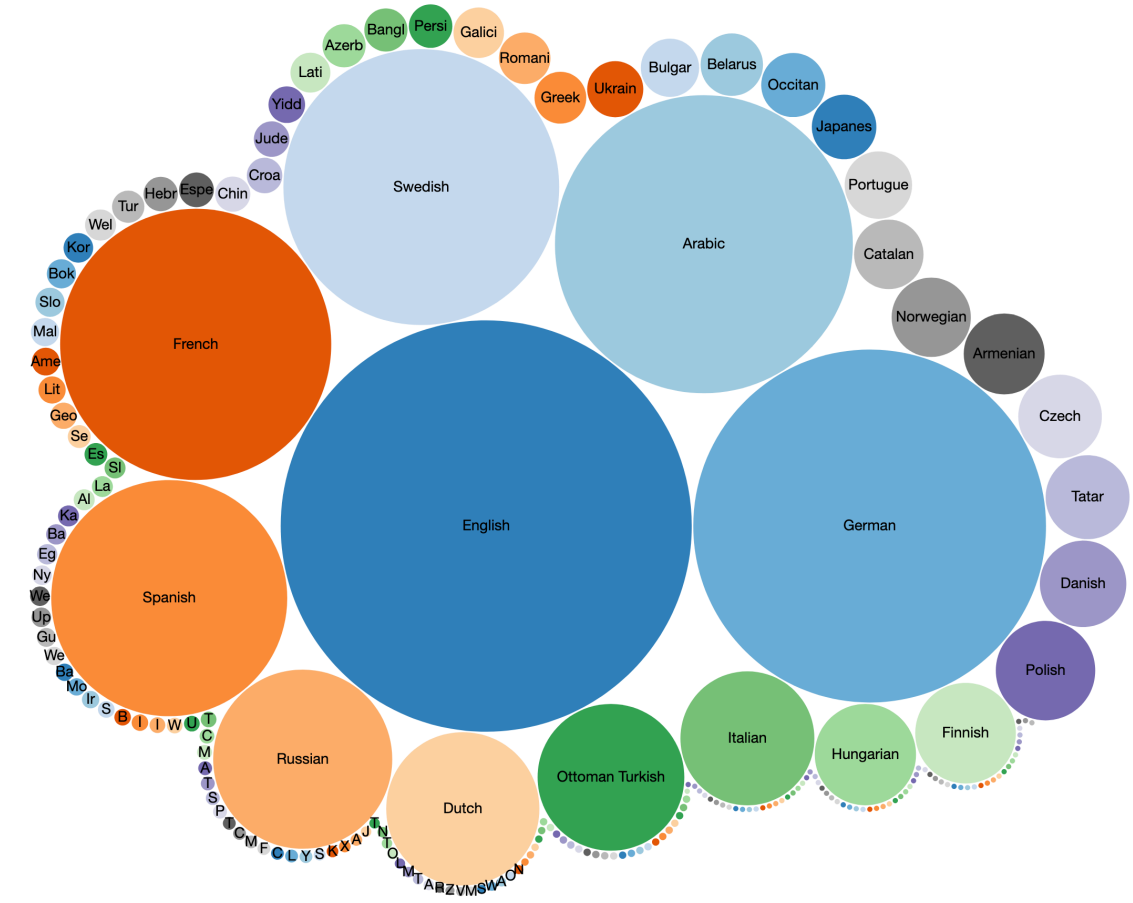
- name: `languages_before-2024-03-18-disp_bubble`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: <https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/dMk3vPTaZkuiqe804Wqeqkmi8SooO260qSCmAG08MI7 >



Publication languages on Wikidata after our import

Bubble chart of publication languages (items created before 8 August 2024). Note the surprising prominence of Swedish.

- name: `languages_before-2024-08-08-disp_bubble`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: <https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/26dFDncq2WMkmei8eg26qwISOKyMAmioq6Co8WwUIKQ >



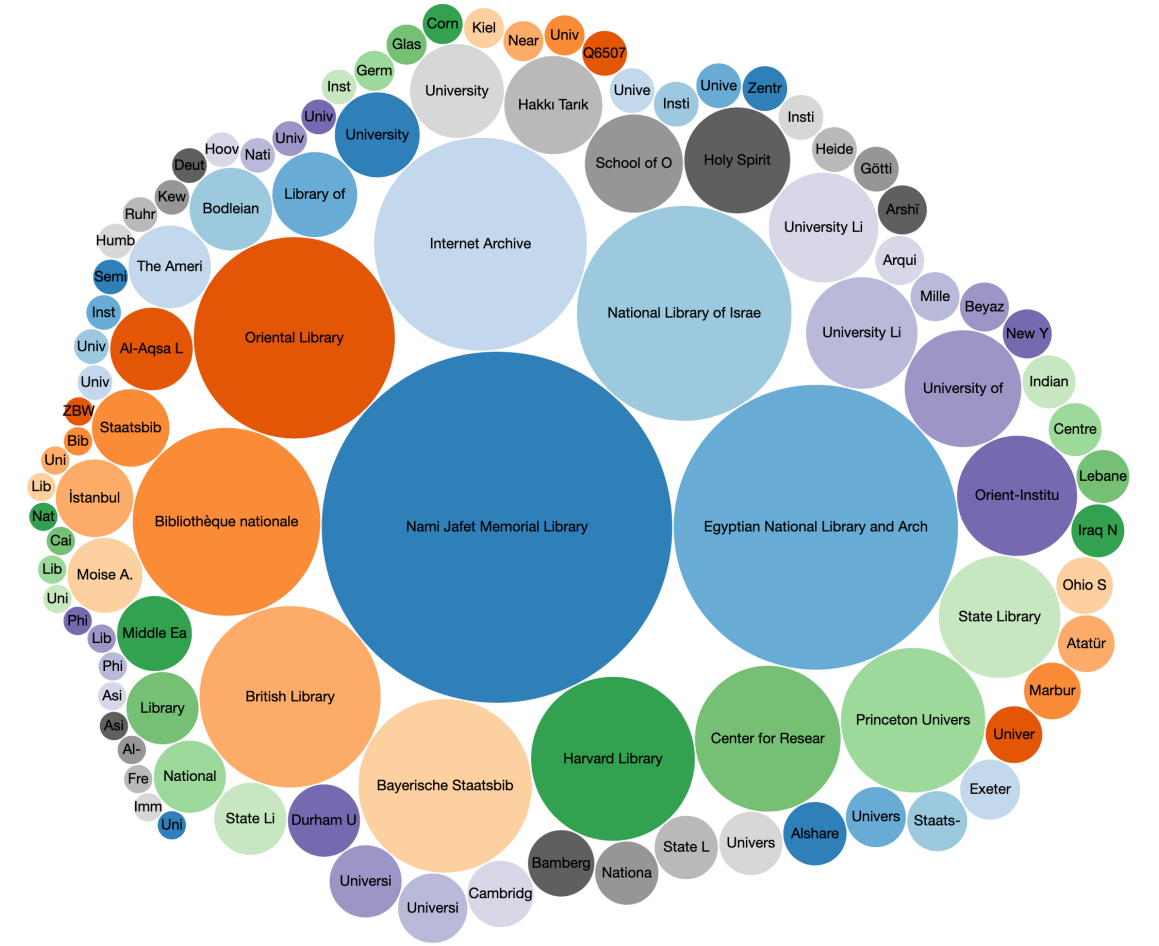
Holdings and digitised collections

Queries that focus on the holdings and digitised collections of Arabic periodicals

Bubble graph of holdings

Bubble graph of collections of Arabic periodicals. The size of bubbles correspondes to the number of periodicals in a specific collection. Note the surprising prominence of the Internet Archive!

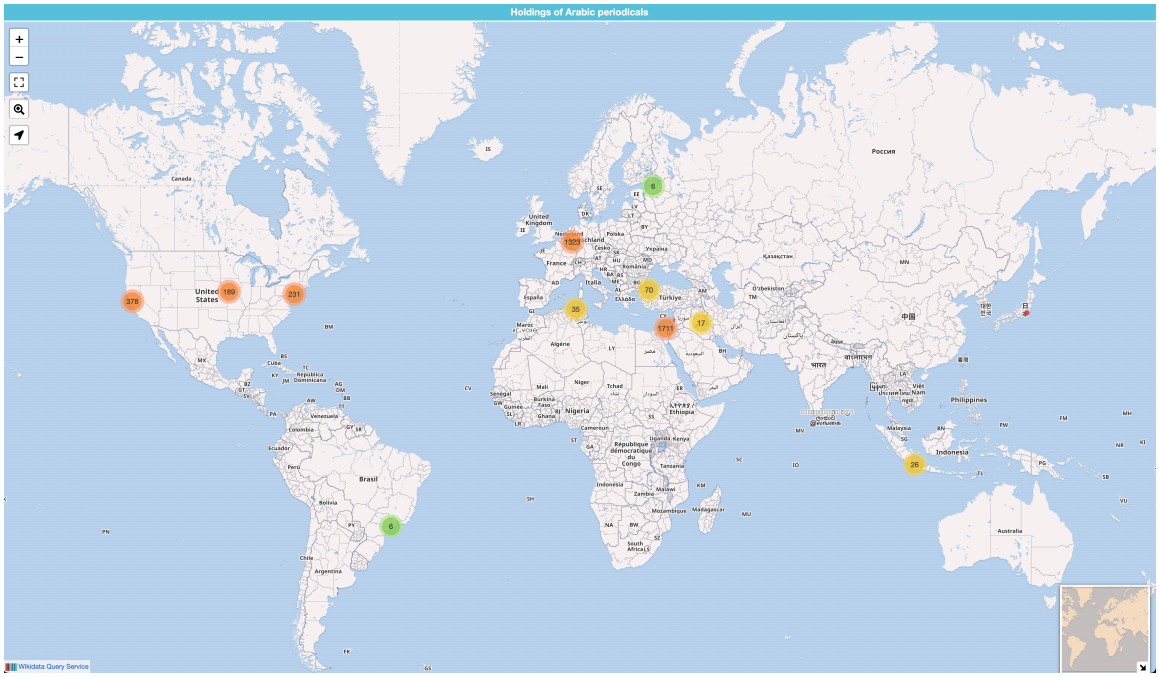
- name: `holdings_periodicals-lang_ar-disp_bubble`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/5jePPWeZe42UCWwCmYyIc2mmcW242euOIeaEUiS0O0j



Map of holdings

Map of Arabic periodicals with kown holdings. Periodicals are mapped to the location of the holding institution.

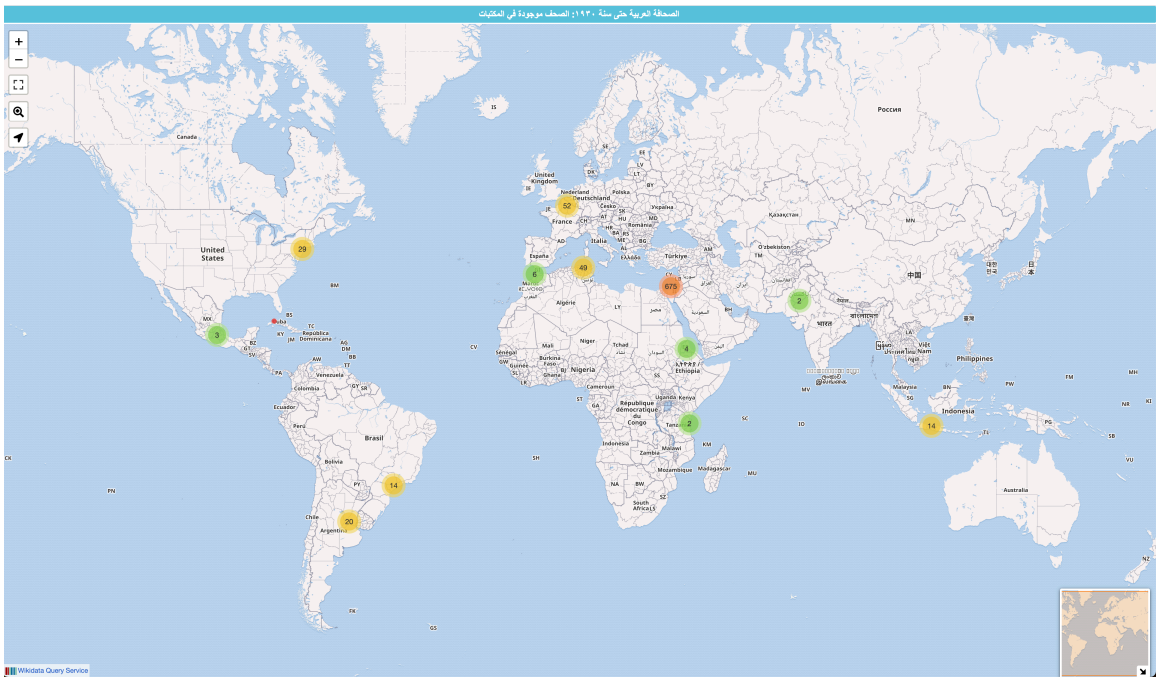
- name: `holdings_periodicals-lang_ar-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/WvUD5eWjtQqKOEC02cQKmCQguM2okyIaAW46giAaGuX



Map of periodicals with known holdings

Map of Arabic periodicals with known holdings. Periodicals are mapped to the publication place.

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-holdings-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/w3zZsU79KQEuYUk8kk2MEwGaQg08w0GkYo2wYSksGGY



Periodicals with only a single known holding

List of Arabic periodicals with a single known holding. This list is of utmost importance if you had some resources for digitisation and wanted to spend them as effectively as possible on unique artefacts.

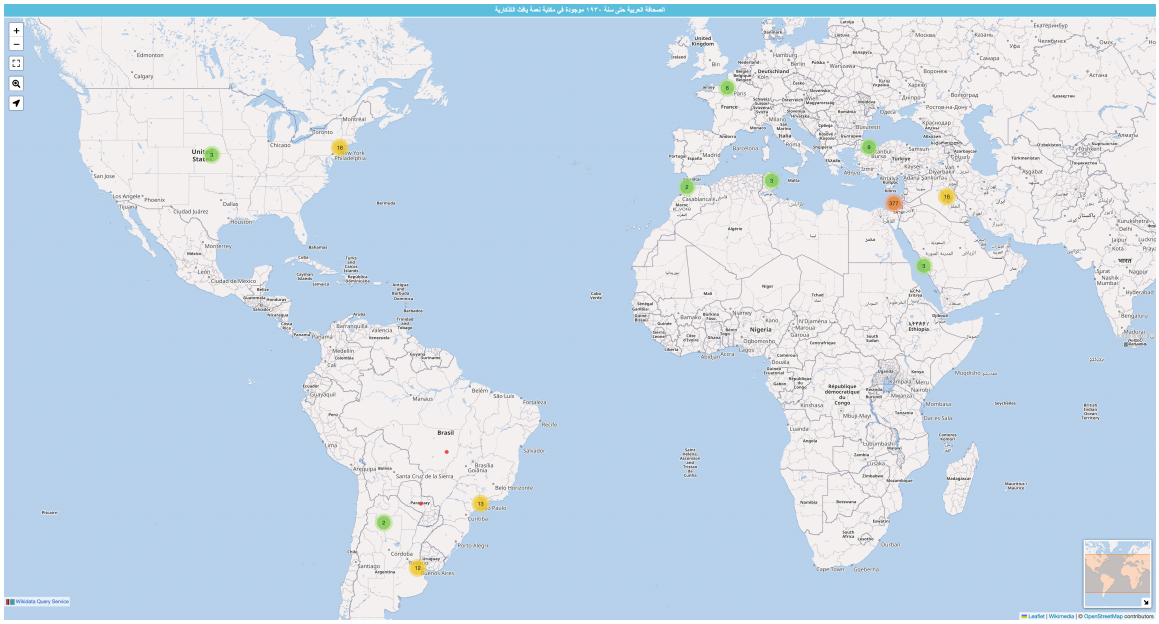
- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-holdings-filter_count-1`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/sKOFbBpaueKiSgawYUIKUQyeaaiewS2IaGWqeSQ6euq

Maps of specific collections

Maps of Arabic periodicals in a specific holding

American University of Beirut (AUB)

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-filter_collection-aub-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/qmTkCttCikGMoCI8kSkS4Uq8MuyS8EyMKS6KaOQQqsf



Orient-Institut Beirut (OIB)

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-filter_collection-oib-disp_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata

Map of Arabic periodicals in the OIB's Library

Editors

images of editors

Images of editors of Arabic periodicals found on WikiCommons

- name: `editors-disp_imagegrid`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/vWy7oAd56GAWYscO0wyQkQ2M4UQmG4m4AMk8MiAcSEw

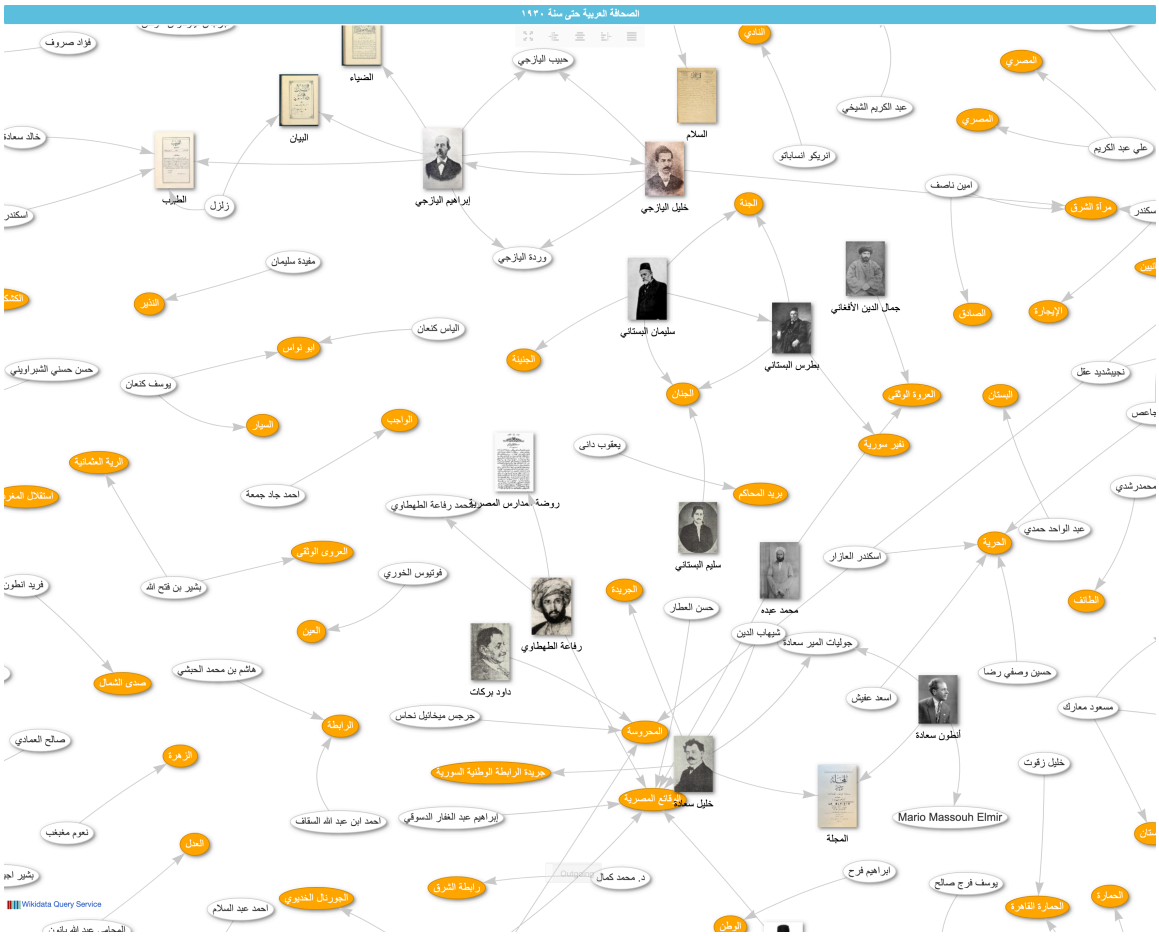
Age of editors

Table listing the gender (mostly male) and age of editors of Arabic periodicals at the first year of publication

- name: `editors-filter_age`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/TUDcmZHcJcEiC00OWscW2omkcmiSsEa0kIgyeQwwMoe

Social network of editors and their relatives.

- name: `editors-social-network-disp_graph`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/2luB9FLaquKoGoAqcU2mGK6YsWiUiOWUCakOyYEsUOi

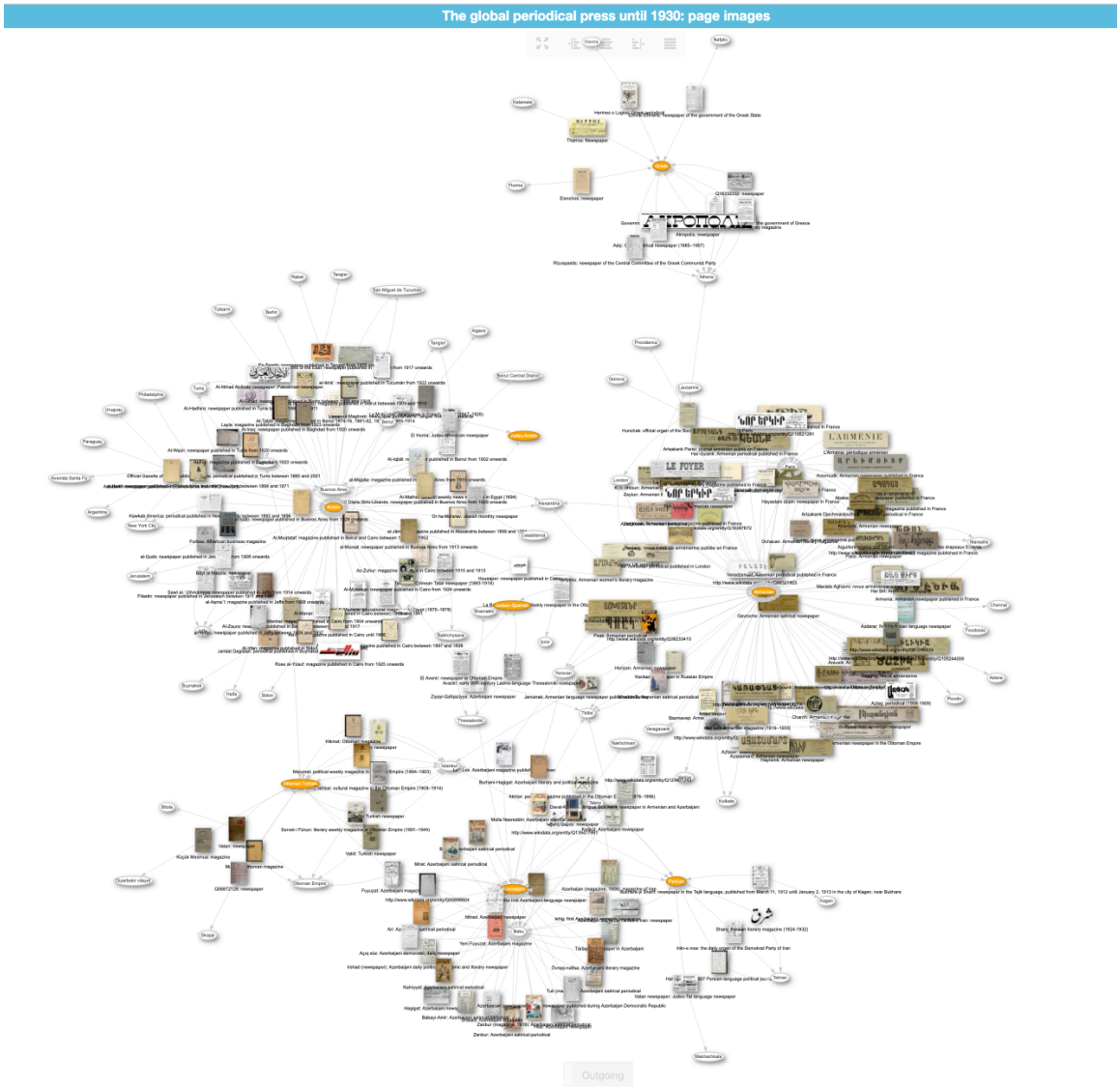


Front pages

Network of front pages, locations and publication languages

Graph view connecting front pages, publication places and publication languages. This allows to quickly check for any trends or specificities.

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-image-disp_graph`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/q8HKXkolw8uYgywMEgGsywuqWSMymGWyCEIEoiqku4Z



ice

Dimensions

Page dimensions

Basic table for periodicals with known dimensions. This is mostly based on information imported from library catalogues, which frequently record the height of an item in their collection

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-dimensions`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/1yFIBRrWui6qQQAGAimCOW8gYg08syeWCmIAkG0sSai

Geographic regions

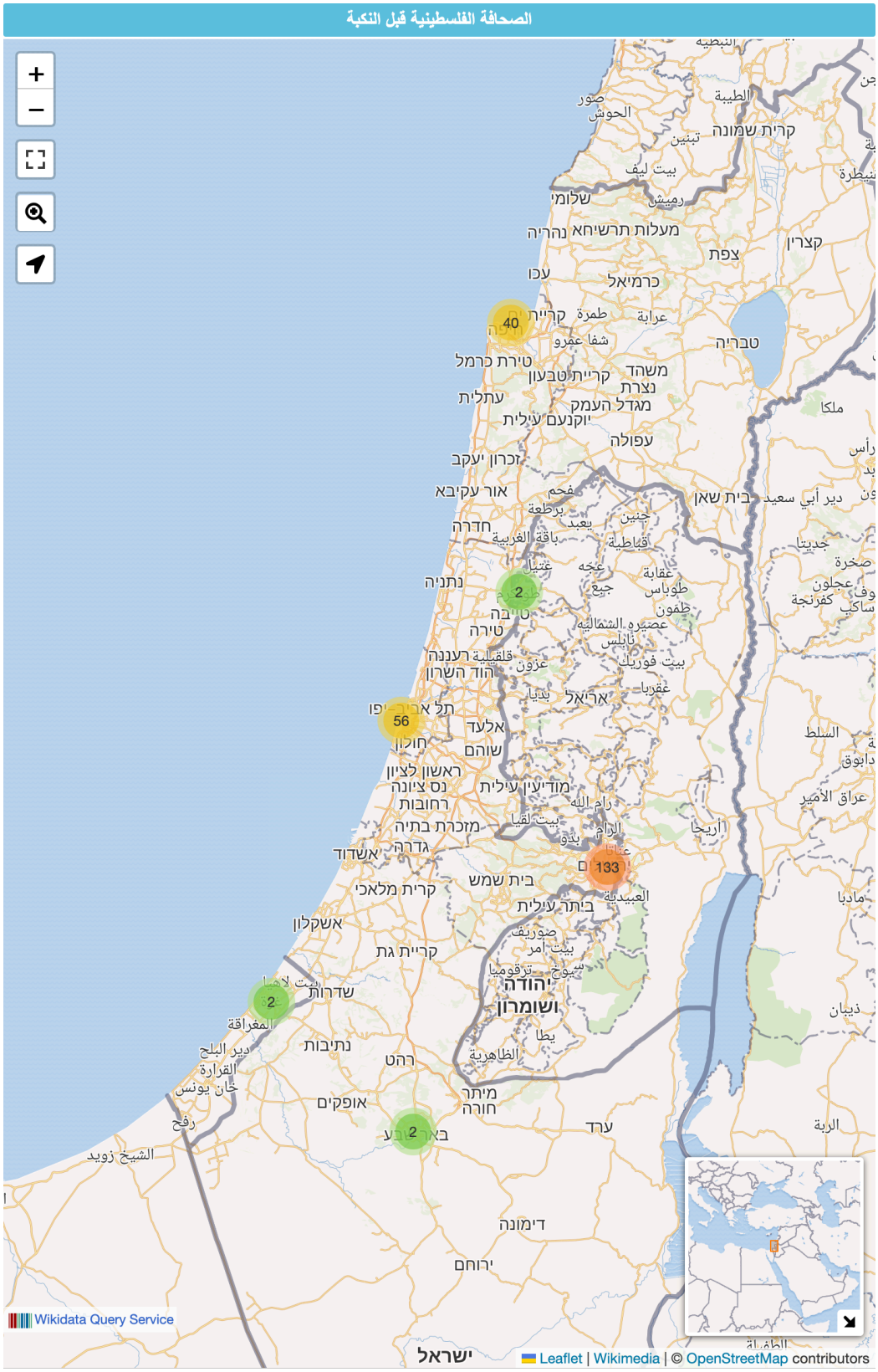
Palestine before the *Nakba*

Instead of a rectangular bounding box, Palestine is defined by an explicitly provided list of publication places.

Note that Wikidata relies on OpenStreetMap for mapping, which not just defaults to Hebrew toponyms within the 1967 borders of Israel but also superimposes the ultra-nationalist Israeli label of "Judea and Samaria" for the illegally occupied Westbank.

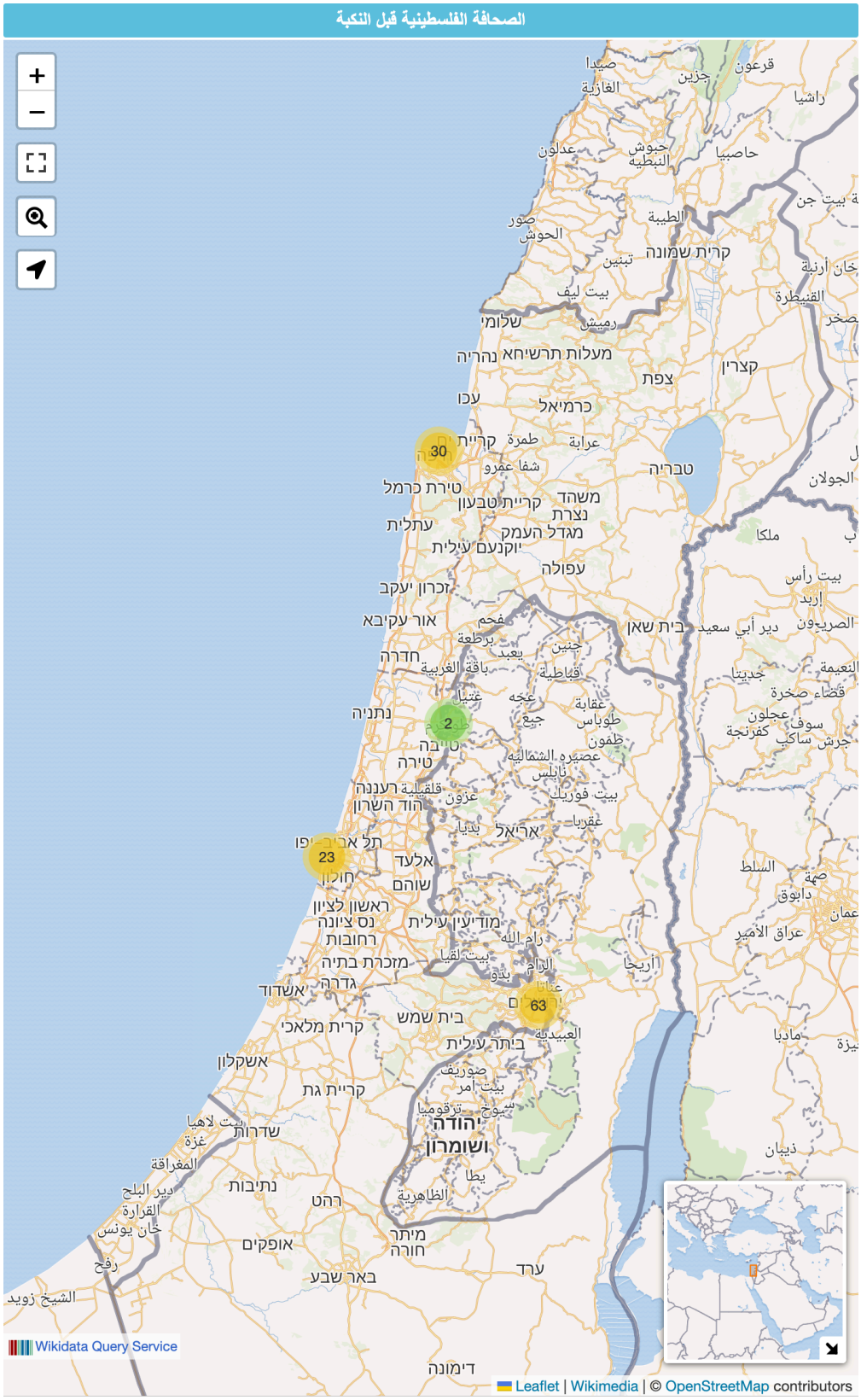
Map of periodicals

- name: `palestine-1948_periodicals_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/WSB7DBbD7oYkIU2k8KoksQkaauOu8ew8cEOs4CCyCID


الصحافة الفلسطينية قبل النكبة
40
2
56
133
2
2
Wikidata Query Service
Leaflet | Wikimedia | © OpenStreetMap contributors

Map of periodicals with holdings

- name: `palestine-1948_periodicals-holdings_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/FastY9YqoKky0AAggWsk4mMeQW284SIOkIGGiEEMQKd


الصحافة الفلسطينية قبل النكبة
30
2
23
63
Wikidata Query Service
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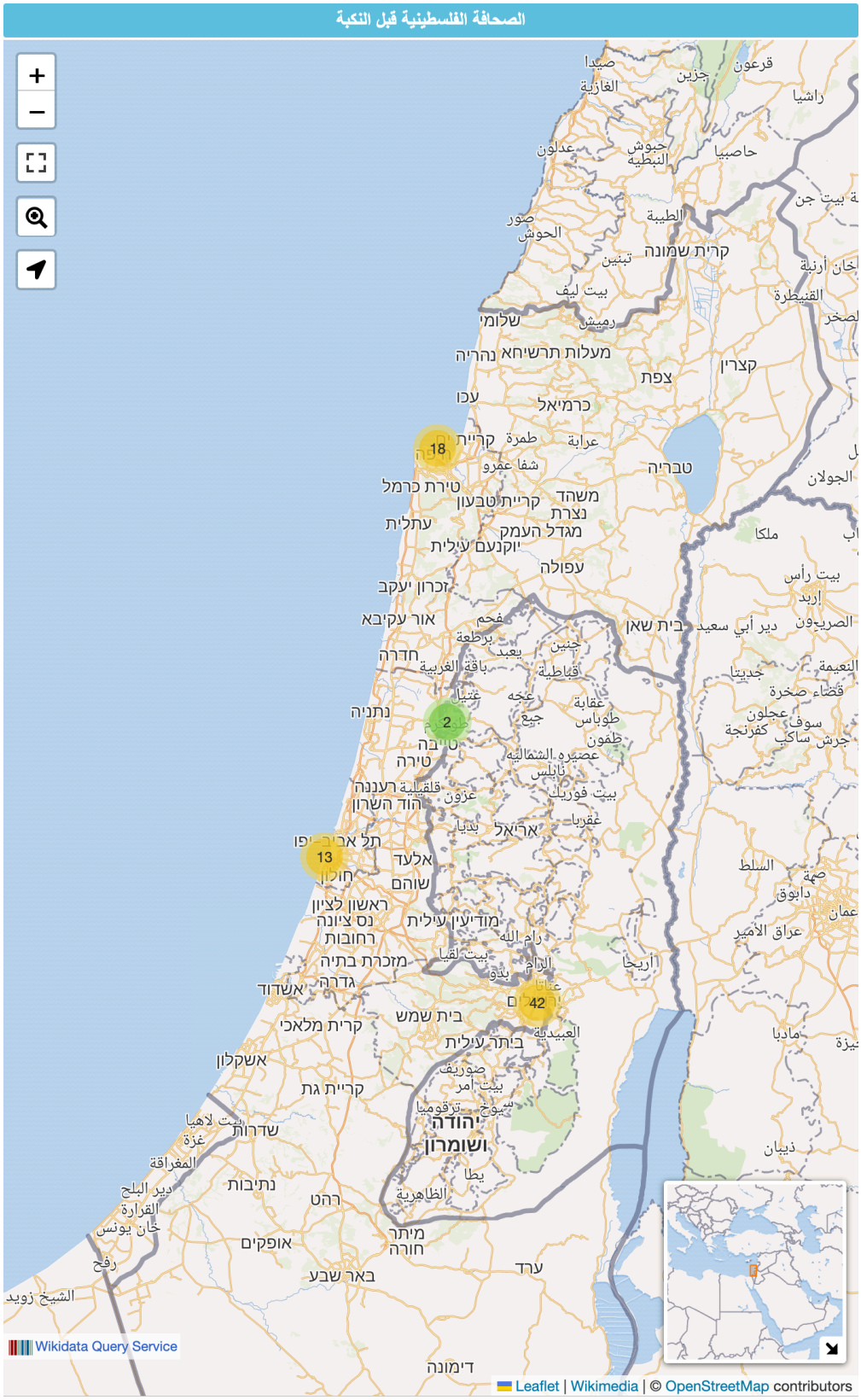
Map of holdings

- name: `palestine-1948_periodicals-holdings_map-collection`
- link: [SPARQL query on Wikidata][rq:palestine-1948_periodicals-holdings_map-collection]
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/Bsfc1wk38K2WEaQk84qGkyeOkggEea8kGuSMqgGOEU1

[][rq:palestine-1948_periodicals-holdings_map-collection]

Map of periodicals with digitised collections

- name: `palestine-1948_periodicals-digitised_map`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/aDYfGc5U3MCeOaWIg0OcKoYK2MMweuiOo8KGA26yOib


الصحافة الفلسطينية قبل النكبة
18
2
13
42
Wikidata Query Service
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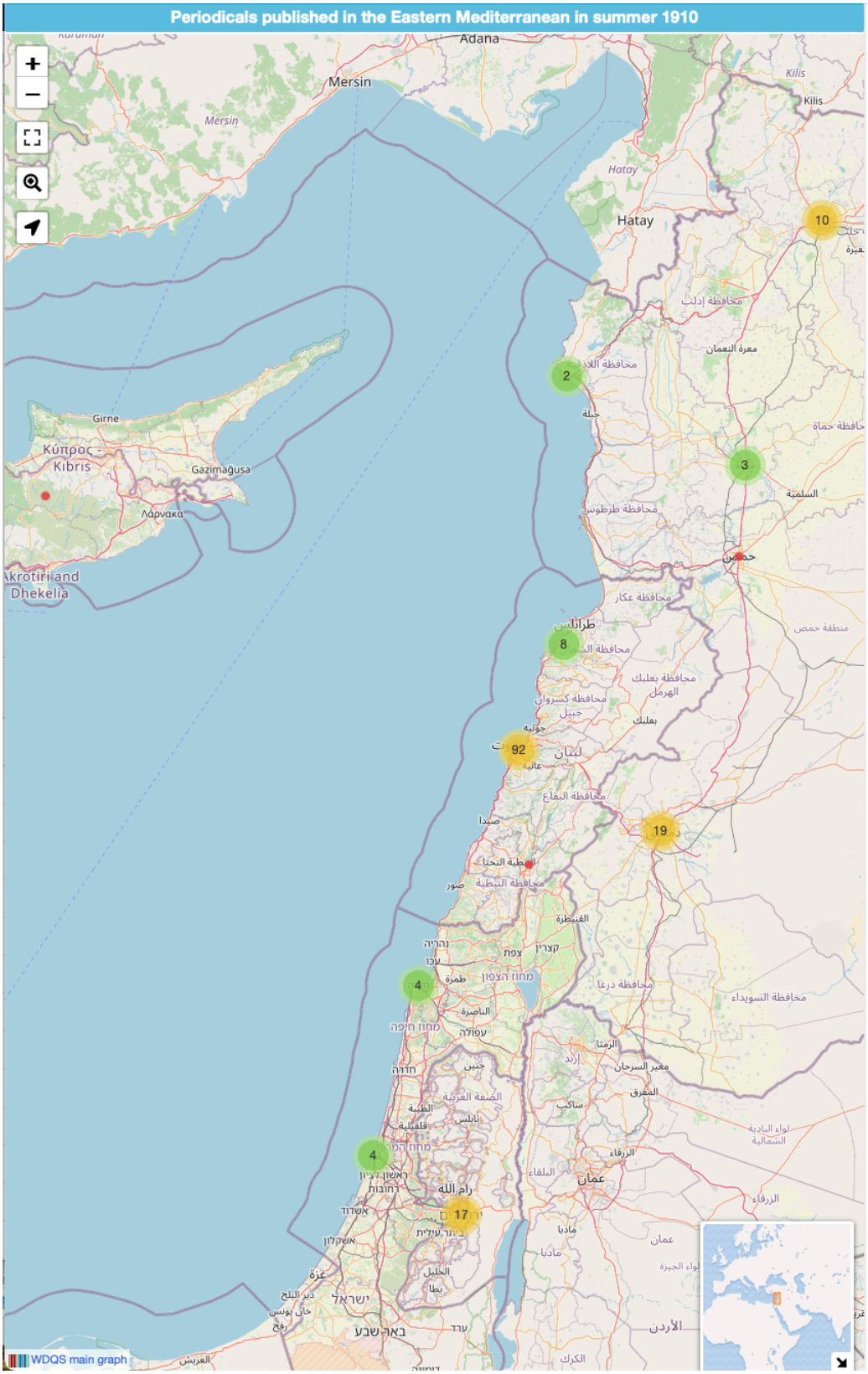
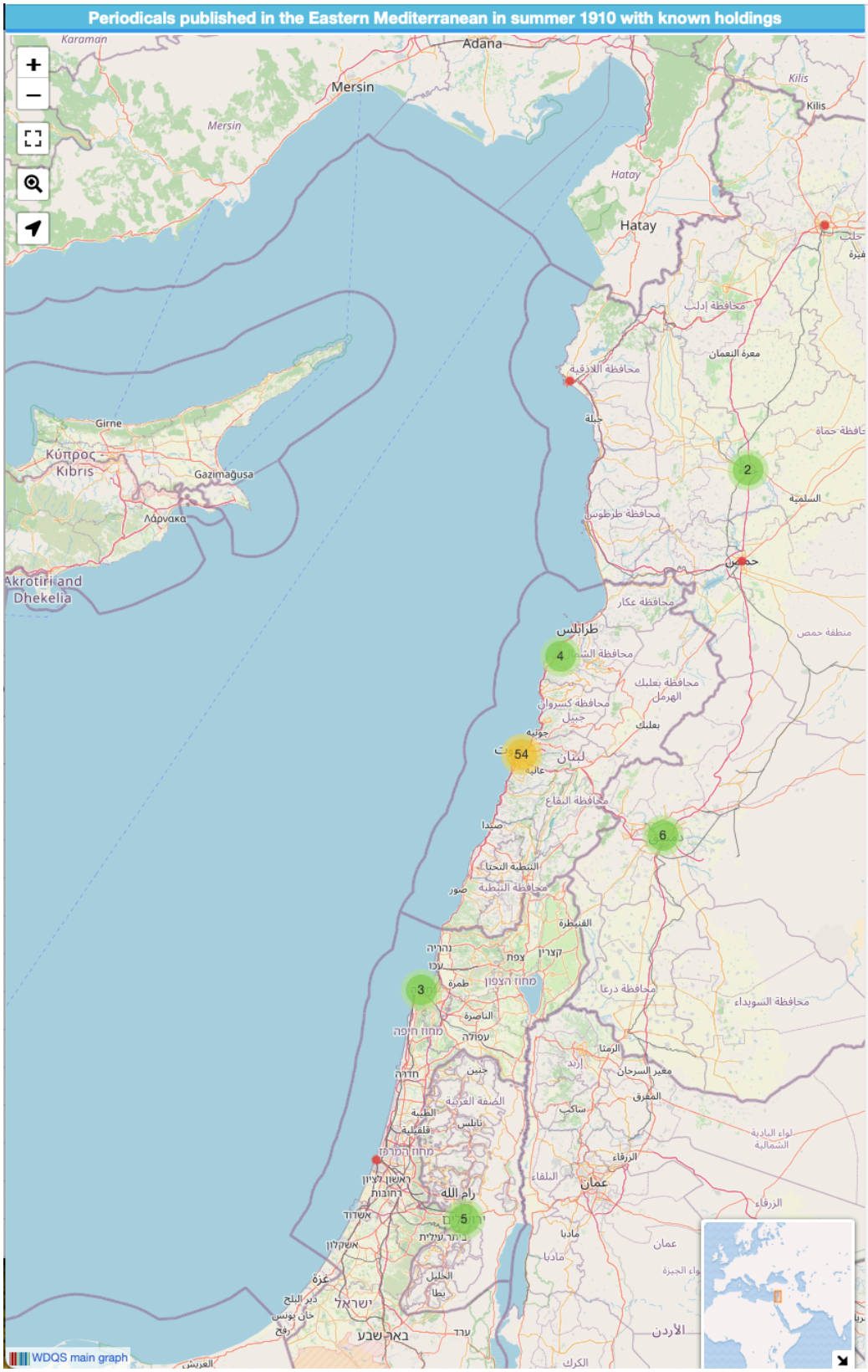
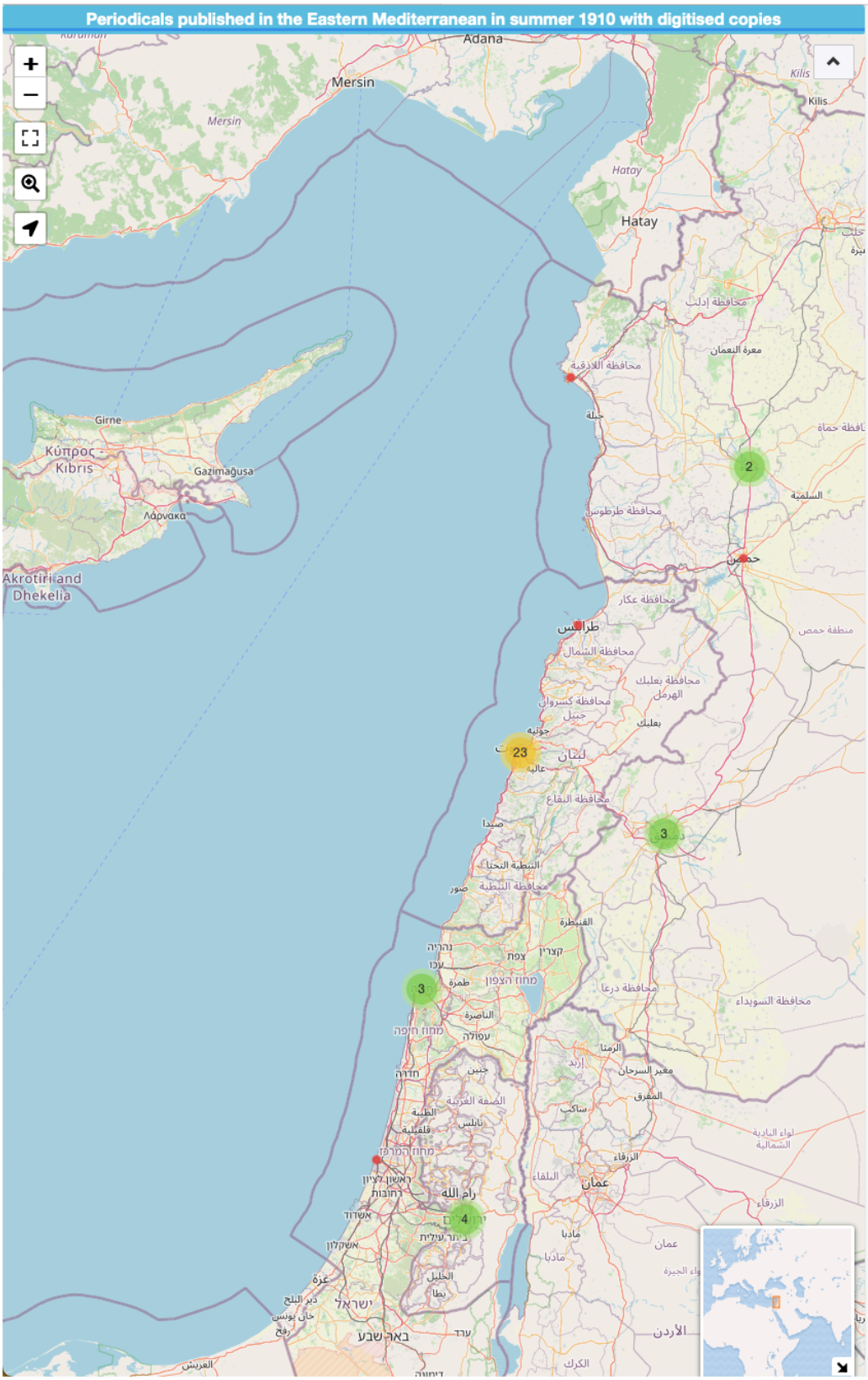
Levant



Map of newspapers published in the Eastern Mediterranean during the summer of 1910, [SPARQL query on Wikidata] [rq:map-levant-1910-06].



Map of newspapers published in the Eastern Mediterranean during the summer of 1910 with known holdings, [SPARQL query on Wikidata][rq:map-levant-1910-06-holdings].



Map of newspapers published in the Eastern Mediterranean during the summer of 1910 with digitised copies, [SPARQL query on Wikidata][rq:map-levant-1910-06-digitised].

external IDs

These can be used for further queries to external APIs

Hathitrust IDs

Table that returns QIDs and Hahtitrust IDs, which can be used to query HathiTrust for copies via `https://catalog.hathitrust.org/api/volumes/full/recordnumber/{ID}.json`

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-filter_ids-hathi`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/rLaytNA78qsiw2uAuusEMCwESG8yEwqIOWE2AOwwoIZ

OCLC IDs

Table that returns QIDs and OCLC IDs (worldcat), which can be used to query HathiTrust for copies via `https://catalog.hathitrust.org/api/volumes/full/oclc/{ID}.json`

- name: `periodicals-lang_ar-filter_ids-oclc`
- link: SPARQL query on Wikidata
- obsolete link: https://query-chest.toolforge.org/redirect/kChWMCQzq2YAy6o0SsAikiouKgIMaqWIos0WwkwuCoa